

**UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT
NORTHERN DISTRICT OF FLORIDA
PENSACOLA DIVISION**

DEBRA NELSON,

Plaintiff,

vs.

CASE NO.: 3:25-cv-1447-MCR-ZCB

**AMENTUM GOVERNMENT
SERVICES PARENT HOLDINGS
LLC, CLARENCE XANDER,
JANICE HUGHES, HEATHER
GUNN, DAKOTA THOMAS,
ELIAS VELASQUEZ, and YUSEF
ABDUL-JAMI,**

Defendants.

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REPORT OF PARTIES' RULE 26(f) PLANNING CONFERENCE

In accordance with Federal Rule of Civil Procedure 26(f) and Local Rule 16.1, N.D. Fla. L.R., Plaintiff, DEBRA NELSON (“Plaintiff”), and Defendants, AMENTUM GOVERNMENT SERVICES PARENT HOLDINGS LLC, CLARENCE XANDER, JANICE HUGHES, HEATHER GUNN, DAKOTA THOMAS, ELIAS VELASQUEZ, and YUSEF ABDUL-JAMI (“Defendants”) (hereinafter collectively referred to as “the Parties”), hereby submit this Report of Parties’ Rule 26(f) Planning Conference.

I. Conference.

The Parties conducted an initial Rule 26(f) planning conference via telephone on December 22, 2025. Debra Nelson, Pro Se Plaintiff, and Lindsay D. Swiger, counsel for Defendants, attended the telephone conference. The Parties have subsequently conferred via email regarding this Report. The Parties had an oral conversation and have fully complied with Rule 26(f), Fed. R. Civ. P.

II. Discovery Plan Pursuant to Fed. R. Civ. P. 26(f).

a. Proposals as to what changes should be made in the timing, form, or requirement for disclosures under Rule 26(a), including a statement as to when disclosures under Rule 26(a)(1) will be made.

The Parties do not propose any changes to the requirement or form of disclosures under Fed. R. Civ. P. 26(a). The Parties agree to exchange the information required by Fed. R. Civ. P. 26(a)(1) on or before **January 30, 2026**.

b. The subjects on which discovery may be needed, when discovery should be completed, and whether discovery should be conducted in phases or be limited to or focused on particular issues.

The Parties do not believe discovery in this matter should be conducted in phases. The Parties are unable to reach agreement on the subjects on which discovery may be needed and when discovery should be completed.

Plaintiff proposes a shorter discovery period because the factual issues in this case are not complex and are largely confined to Plaintiff's employment, two discrete leave-of-absence periods, the termination decision, and alleged retaliation.

A substantial portion of the discoverable documents has already been produced and filed with the operative complaints as exhibits. It is Plaintiff's position that discovery is expected to be primarily documentary with a limited number of witnesses. Accordingly, Plaintiff proposes that fact discovery be completed by **March 30, 2026**, which Plaintiff submits provides sufficient time for discovery to be completed efficiently without unnecessary delay. Plaintiff submits that discovery will include, without limitation, matters relating to Plaintiff's employment, leave of absence periods, termination, alleged retaliation, internal investigations, disciplinary actions, communications with counsel and third parties, funding and compliance issues, and damages.

Defendants propose that the deadline to complete discovery in this matter be **October 30, 2026**. Defendants anticipate that discovery will be conducted on matters relevant to Plaintiff's claims and Defendants' defenses and affirmative defenses to Plaintiff's claims.

c. Issues about disclosure, discovery, or preservation of electronically stored information, including the form or forms in which it should be produced.

Discovery of electronically stored information ("ESI") will be governed by the applicable Federal Rules of Civil Procedure and the Local Rules of this Court. The Parties agree to confer in good faith regarding the production of ESI and to address any issues that may arise during the discovery process.

At this time, the scope of ESI discovery has not been fully determined.

Plaintiff does not anticipate extensive ESI discovery, as the relevant documents are limited, discrete, and largely already part of the record.

The Parties agree that, unless otherwise agreed or ordered, ESI will be produced in a reasonably usable format, which may include searchable PDF or native format where appropriate.

d. Issues about claims of privilege or protection as trial-preparation materials, including whether to ask the court to include their agreement in an order.

The Parties agree that the Federal Rules of Civil Procedure, Federal Rules of Evidence, and Local Rules of this Court shall govern claims of privilege or protection as trial-preparation materials, as well as the inadvertent production of privileged information. The Parties agree to confer in good faith to agree on procedures to deal with the inadvertent production of privileged information, if not otherwise covered by Rule 26(b)(5)(B), Federal Rules of Civil Procedure, and Rule 502, Federal Rules of Evidence.

e. Changes in the limitations on discovery imposed under the Federal or Local Rules, and other limitations to be imposed.

The Parties do not propose any changes in the limitations on discovery. The Parties request that the applicable Federal Rules of Civil Procedure and Local Rules of this Court govern interrogatories, requests for admissions, the number of depositions, and the time permitted for the taking of depositions.

f. Any other orders that should be entered by the Court under Rule 26(c) or Rule 16(b) and (c).

The Parties will confer regarding a proposed protective order governing confidential information.

It is Plaintiff's position that any confidentiality designation should not, absent further Court order, restrict the discovery, use, or filing of witness statements, investigative materials, or disciplinary records relevant to Plaintiff's claims, including claims for defamation, retaliation, or discrimination.

The Parties respectfully request that the deadlines and agreements set forth in this Report be approved by the Court for the reasons set forth more fully herein.

Respectfully submitted this 9th day of January, 2026.

DEBRA NELSON

/s/ Debra Nelson
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Attorneys for Defendants

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I HEREBY CERTIFY that on this 9th day of January 2026, a true and correct copy of the foregoing was electronically filed with the Court by using the CM/ECF system and served via e-mail to the following *pro se* Plaintiff:

Debra Nelson

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

Pro Se Plaintiff

/s/ Lindsay D. Swiger
Lindsay D. Swiger